How the renewal process lives in the CRM (Salesforce)

The forecast, statuses, product lines, churn and alerts in Part 1 are CRM fields, formulas and Flows. They are not a spreadsheet, and not a separate tool. `renewal_tracker.xlsx` is a mock-up of this design. Outside the CRM, n8n only sends the approved CPQ quote, updates the status and chases the signature (Part 3). It never prices anything.

Workbook tab	Lives in Salesforce as
Triage	List view on Renewal opportunities, sorted by Priority and ARR at risk
Pipeline	Opportunity (Renewal record types: Manual and Auto)
Products	Opportunity Product (line items): the Renewals Manager sets the line type and new numbers only
Opp summary	Roll-ups and the Churn section on the Opportunity
Monthly report	Summary report grouped by Renewal Quarter and Renewal Month, filterable by CSM and Region
Probability	Renewal probability formula (or a Custom Metadata matrix)

1. Renewal lifecycle

1. When the current renewal is closed won, the owner ticks **Create renewal opportunity** on the close screen. It is required, unless the contract is ending.
2. A Flow creates the **next renewal opportunity** straight away:
    - Renewal Date = **service start date of the next term** (current contract end + 1 day).
    - Each product line is copied with **Original ARR = the ARR just closed × 1.05** (the contractual uplift is in the renewal value from day one).
    - Renewal Type, Notice Period, CSM and Region are copied from the contract and account.
3. The renewal therefore exists for the whole year. It sits in *Not started* (manual) or *Renewing: no blockers* (auto) until the tasks in section 6 bring it forward.

2. Renewal opportunity

Core and forecast (maintained by Renewals; the formulas are automatic)

Field	Type	Logic
Renewal Date	Date	Service start date of the next term (contract end + 1). Never edited by reps.
Close Date (standard)	Date	**Expected** close date, kept up to date by the owner. Drives the in-quarter rule and standard forecasting.
Renewal Type	Picklist	Manual · Auto. Sets the record type, so each type gets its own status path.
Renewal Status	Picklist (values depend on record type)	**Manual:** Not started · Engaging customer · Negotiation · Quoted · Waiting for PO · PO received · **Closed won** (new) · Cancelled. **Auto:** Renewing: no blockers · Billing blocker · At risk: before notice deadline · At risk: notice deadline passed · Notice received · Renewed · Cancelled. Each has written exit criteria and the evidence rules in section 5.
Term (years), Payment Schedule	Number, picklist (Annual · Upfront)	Drive the uplift rule in section 3.
Notice Period (days)	Number	From the contract: how long before the Renewal Date the customer must give notice to cancel.

Field	Type	Logic
Notice Deadline	Formula (date)	`Renewal_Date__c - Notice_Period_Days__c`
Days to Renewal	Formula (number)	`Renewal_Date__c - TODAY()`
Renewal Window	Formula (text)	`IF(Days_to_Renewal__c < 0, "Overdue", IF(Days_to_Renewal__c <= 30, "0-30", IF(Days_to_Renewal__c <= 60, "31-60", IF(Days_to_Renewal__c <= 90, "61-90", ">90"))))`
Overdue	Formula (checkbox)	`AND(Days_to_Renewal__c < 0, NOT(IsClosed))`
Renewal Month, Renewal Quarter, Quarter End	Formulas	`TEXT(YEAR(Renewal_Date__c)) & "-" & LPAD(TEXT(MONTH(Renewal_Date__c)), 2, "0")` · `"Q" & TEXT(CEILING(MONTH(Renewal_Date__c) / 3)) & " " & TEXT(YEAR(Renewal_Date__c))` · `ADDMONTHS(DATE(YEAR(Renewal_Date__c), CEILING(MONTH(Renewal_Date__c) / 3) * 3, 1), 1) - 1`
Renewal Probability	Formula (percent)	Renewal Status × Renewal Window. See below.
Counts in Quarter	Formula (checkbox)	`CloseDate <= Quarter_End__c`
Forecast Probability	Formula (percent)	`IF(Counts_in_Quarter__c, Renewal_Probability__c, 0)`
Weighted New ARR	Formula (currency)	`New_ARR__c * Forecast_Probability__c`
ARR at Risk	Formula (currency)	`New_ARR__c * (1 - Renewal_Probability__c)`
Forecast Bucket	Formula (text)	On time / Late / Slips quarter / Lost. See below.
Target Status, Target Date, Target Probability, Weighted After Actions	Picklist, date, formulas	Where the next actions should take the renewal, and the **forecast of the forecast** that results.

Triage (replaces a typed-in rank, which goes stale within days)

Field	Type	Logic
Priority	Formula (text)	**P1:** overdue, Escalate Today ticked, or ≤30 days and still early or blocked. **P2:** ≤60 days and not yet Quoted (manual) or not *Renewing: no blockers* (auto). **P3:** everything else. The triage list sorts by Priority, then ARR at Risk.
Next Action, Next Action Owner (Renewals · CSM · Finance · Legal), Next Action Due	Text, picklist, date	Kept current by the owner
Escalate Today, Escalation Note	Checkbox, text	Feeds the daily escalation email

CSM section (maintained by the CSM)

Field	Type	Logic
CSM, Region	Lookup, formula	From the account. Used to filter every report.
Health	Picklist	Green · Yellow · Red

Field	Type	Logic
Usage Change 90d	Percent	From product usage data (workflow executions), synced daily
Usage Signal	Formula (text)	`IF(Usage_Change_90d__c >= 0.2, "Over-usage", IF(Usage_Change_90d__c <= -0.2, "Under-usage", ""))`
Adoption Plan	Text	Required when Usage Signal = Under-usage

Churn section (on the opportunity, not on the product lines)

Field	Type	Logic
Churned Amount	Roll-up (currency)	SUM of the Downgrade line changes, plus the Original ARR of Churn lines. A negative number.
Churn Category	Picklist	**Regrettable**: revenue lost to n8n for good. **Non-regrettable**: the revenue is kept elsewhere at n8n. Required when Churned Amount < 0.
Churn Reason	Dependent picklist	**Regrettable:** Budget cut · Price · Competitor · Moved to free Community edition · Product gaps · Support or service · Low adoption / champion left · Company closed. **Non-regrettable:** Migrated to another n8n product (e.g. self-hosted → n8n Cloud) · Consolidated into another n8n contract (merger, acquired by an existing customer) · Moved to another legal entity.
Churn Notes	Text	Context for win-back and product feedback

Renewal Probability. For manual renewals, late statuses rise as the date gets closer and early statuses fall. For auto-renewals, a clean renewal rises as the date gets closer, and an open blocker or risk falls:

```
CASE(TEXT(Renewal_Status__c),
  "Not started",       CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.05, "0-30", 0.10, "31-60", 0.20, "61-90",
0.30, 0.35),
  "Engaging customer", CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.10, "0-30", 0.25, "31-60", 0.35, "61-90",
0.45, 0.50),
  "Negotiation",       CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.20, "0-30", 0.40, "31-60", 0.50, "61-90",
0.55, 0.55),
  "Quoted",            CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.50, "0-30", 0.75, "31-60", 0.70, "61-90",
0.65, 0.60),
  "Waiting for PO",    CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.70, "0-30", 0.90, "31-60", 0.85, "61-90",
0.80, 0.75),
  "PO received",       CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.95, "0-30", 0.99, "31-60", 0.97, "61-90",
0.95, 0.90),
  "Closed won", 1,
  "Renewing: no blockers",          CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.40, "0-30", 0.97, "31-60",
0.95, "61-90", 0.92, 0.90),
  "Billing blocker",                CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.40, "0-30", 0.60, "31-60",
0.70, "61-90", 0.75, 0.80),
  "At risk: before notice deadline", CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.20, "0-30", 0.35, "31-60",
0.40, "61-90", 0.45, 0.50),
  "At risk: notice deadline passed", CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0.50, 0.80),
  "Notice received",                CASE(Renewal_Window__c, "Overdue", 0, 0.10),
  "Renewed", 1,
  0)
```

If Finance wants to recalibrate every quarter without an admin, the matrix can move to a Custom Metadata type, with a Flow setting the field each night.

Forecast Bucket

```
IF(ISPICKVAL(Renewal_Status__c, "Cancelled"), "Lost",
 IF(NOT(Counts_in_Quarter__c), "Slips quarter",
  IF(OR(Days_to_Renewal__c < 0,
        AND(Days_to_Renewal__c <= 30,
            OR(ISBLANK(TEXT(Renewal_Status__c)),
               ISPICKVAL(Renewal_Status__c, "Not started"),
               ISPICKVAL(Renewal_Status__c, "Engaging customer"),
               ISPICKVAL(Renewal_Status__c, "Negotiation"),
               ISPICKVAL(Renewal_Status__c, "Billing blocker"),
               ISPICKVAL(Renewal_Status__c, "At risk: before notice deadline"),
               ISPICKVAL(Renewal_Status__c, "Notice received")))),
     "Late", "On time")))
```

Standard forecasting. A Flow sets the standard Forecast Category from the bucket, so Collaborative Forecasts and the VP's roll-up use the same logic:

Condition	Forecast Category
On time and probability ≥ 85%	Commit
On time or Late	Best Case
Slips quarter	Pipeline
Cancelled	Omitted

3. Product lines: the Renewals Manager's only inputs

The Renewals Manager (who owns the renewal) edits **two things per line**: the **Line Type** (Renewal · Upsell · Downgrade · Churn) and the **new numbers** (Change at List, or the new quantity or plan). Salesforce recalculates everything else.

Field	Who	Logic
Line Type	**Renewals Manager**	Renewal · Upsell · Downgrade · Churn
Change at List	**Renewals Manager**	+ for upsell, − for downgrade, at the list price of the new plan
Original ARR (renewal value)	Automatic	Set when the opportunity is created: **ARR just closed × 1.05**, so the contractual uplift is already in. Locked. Every report and forecast uses this number; the uplift is never added on top later.
Year-1 uplift waiver	Renewals	The 5% is already in the renewal value. Waiving it is an exception (e.g. three years paid upfront), counts as a discount, and goes to approval under policy C.
Year 2+ Uplift	Automatic	Multi-year **paid upfront → price locked** (0% from year 2). Multi-year **paid annually → 5% every year**.
Discount (standard)	Renewals	Measured against the renewal value (uplift included)
List Renewal Price	Formula	`IF(ISPICKVAL(Line_Type__c, "Churn"), 0, Original_ARR__c + Change_at_List__c)`
New ARR	Formula	`List_Renewal_Price__c * (1 - BLANKVALUE(Discount, 0))`. A Flow copies it to Sales Price, so the Opportunity Amount equals new ARR.
Δ vs Original, Δ Indicator	Formula	`New_ARR__c - Original_ARR__c`, with `IMAGE(IF(Delta_ARR__c >= 0, "/img/samples/color_green.gif", "/img/samples/color_red.gif"), "", 12, 12)`: **green for growth, red for contraction**

Field	Who	Logic
Approval Required	Formula	Policy C, using the line Discount with the opportunity's Term and Payment Terms: None / Finance / VP Customer Success

Upsell = its own opportunity. When the Renewals Manager sets a line to Upsell, or Usage Signal = Over-usage, a Flow opens a linked **Upsell opportunity** (Expansion record type) for the added ARR. Expansion is then forecast in its own pipeline and never inflates the renewal number. If it signs together with the renewal, both go on one order form but are booked separately.

Roll-ups on the opportunity: Original ARR · New ARR · Upsell (mirrors the linked Upsell opportunity) · Churned Amount · Price Concession (`MIN(0, New_ARR__c - List_Total__c)`, i.e. revenue given up below the renewal value) · Net Change and Net Change % (red/green).

4. Annual uplift communication

The 5% uplift is in every contract. **One bulk notice goes to all customers in January**, saying the contractual uplift applies at each renewal date. No per-renewal notice is sent. The uplifted price is shown again where the customer sees it before paying:

- **Manual renewals:** in the quote, at T−60.
- **Auto-renewals:** in an invoice preview, about 45 days before the renewal date.

5. Guardrails (validation rules)

Rule	Logic
Status required	`AND(NOT(IsClosed), ISBLANK(TEXT(Renewal_Status__c)))`
Quoted needs the quote	The quote file must be uploaded to Files with Document Type = Quote. A Flow ticks Quote Attached on upload; the rule blocks Quoted while it's unticked.
Waiting for PO needs the accepted order form	Signed or accepted order form uploaded (Document Type = Order Form)
PO received needs the PO	PO Number filled and the PO file uploaded
Closed won needs closure	PO received (or signature date for no-PO customers), and the Create renewal opportunity decision made
Churn needs a reason	Churned Amount < 0 requires Churn Category and Churn Reason
No quote above policy without approval	Can't move to Quoted while Approval Required ≠ None and Approval Status ≠ Approved
Original ARR is locked	Editable only by admins
Order-form terms	Auto-renewal clause can't be removed, and termination for convenience can't be added, without an approval from Legal (and VP CS for auto-renewal)

6. Alerts and tasks (Flow scheduled paths + report subscriptions)

When	Condition	Action
T−90	Open renewal	CSM task: health and usage review. Manual → Engaging customer.
T−60	Manual	Renewals task: **create the quote in the CPQ**. Once it's approved, the daily renewal alert (Part 3) drafts the renewal email with it for approval.
T−45	Manual, still before Quoted	Alert to Renewals and manager: quote lead time missed

When	Condition	Action
T−45	Auto	Invoice preview check: payment method valid, billing entity correct, uplifted price shown
Notice Deadline − 14	Auto	CSM and Renewals: check cancellation risk before the customer's last day to give notice
Notice Deadline	Auto, At risk, no notice received	Status → *At risk: notice deadline passed*
Billing event	Card expired or payment failed (billing system)	Status → *Billing blocker*; task for Renewals and Finance
Usage sync (daily)	Over-usage	**No automatic charge** unless the contract has an overage clause. Open a linked **Upsell opportunity**, plus a CSM and Renewals task to propose the right execution tier.
Usage sync (daily)	Under-usage	CSM task: adoption plan. Auto → *At risk*.
T−30	Manual, not yet Waiting for PO	Alert to manager; Escalate Today candidate
T−14	Manual, not yet PO received	Daily reminder to the owner
T+1	Overdue	Alert to manager; grace-period clock starts
Daily 8:00	Report subscription with a condition	Count of P1 or Escalate Today > 0 → email to the Renewals Specialist and manager

7. Reports and dashboard

Every report below can be **filtered by CSM and Region**, as well as quarter and month.

- **Renewals by Quarter and Month** (the base report): grouped by Renewal Quarter → Renewal Month. Shows count, Original ARR, New ARR, Weighted New ARR, Overdue ARR and Regrettable Churn.
- **Forecast:** Weighted New ARR by Forecast Bucket (On time · Late · Slips quarter), with quarter retention and on-time rate.
- **Forecast of the forecast:** weighted today next to Weighted After Actions, by renewal.
- **Churn:** Churned Amount by Churn Category → Churn Reason, by CSM and Region.
- **Expansion:** Upsell opportunities linked to renewals, by stage. Kept separate from the renewal forecast.
- **Triage list view:** open renewals inside 60 days, sorted by Priority then ARR at Risk, showing Next Action, Owner, Due and Escalate Today.
- **VP dashboard:**
  - gross and net retention;
  - weighted forecast against target;
  - overdue count and ARR;
  - share of renewals quoted by day 60;
  - regrettable churn by reason.